



Musical instruments



Did you know?

In 1454, a French orchestra hid in a giant pie to surprise guests at a party!



Most instruments belong to one of five groups. Each group makes musical sounds in a different way.

String instruments

These instruments can be strummed, plucked, or bowed.



Sitars are Indian stringed instruments.

Bow scrapes strings.

Four strings

Wooden body

Metal spike to rest on



A double bass is one of the largest instruments. It has a very deep sound.

Percussion

These instruments make a sound when they are hit or shaken.



Maracas are rattles. They make a swishing sound.



Tambourines have jingling metal disks.

Triangles make a clear, tinkling sound.

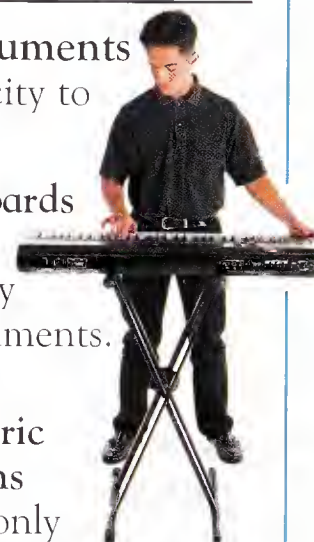


Electronic instruments

These use electricity to make sounds.

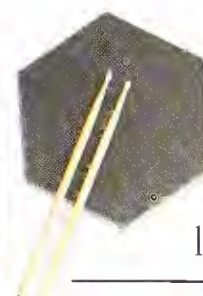
Electric keyboards

can make the sounds of many different instruments.



Electric drums

can only be heard through loudspeakers.



Woodwind

Woodwind instruments make a sound when you blow air inside them.



Oboes have keys for fingers. The mouthpiece is made from a reed.



Accordions blow air with bellows to make sound.

Brass

Musicians blow and vibrate their lips to make brass instruments sound.

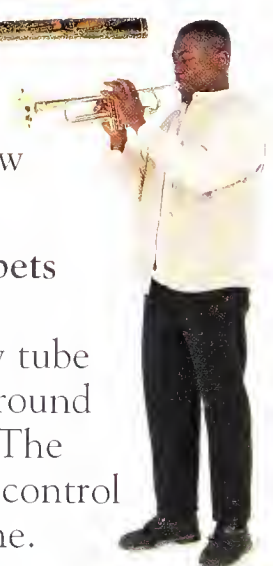


Didgeridoos

are made from a hollow branch.

Trumpets

have a narrow tube bent around twice. The valves control the tone.



French horns

have long pipes that end in a large bell.



Recorders are one of the simplest woodwind instruments.

Flutes are made of metal.

